

# HHPM — Human Harm Prevention Module

**Parent Standard:** Ethical Layer Standard  
**Protocol:** EVIP® — Ethical Virtual Integrity Protocol  
**Category:** Governance & Enforcement  
**Subcategory:** Human Harm Prevention  
**Type:** Ethical Validity Module  
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**Status:** Canonical · Open Module  
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**Compatibility:** OOF® Methodology OS™ · **Ethical Layer Standard** · EVIP® · INTEGROS® · TVL® · UCL™  
**Authority:** OOF®  
**Protection:** MIP® — Methodological Intellectual Property  
**Canonical Language:** English (UCL™)

## Canonical Definition

**Human Harm Prevention Module** defines the structural conditions under which a system, methodology, device, hardware structure, AI environment, autonomous process, or deployment pathway prevents avoidable harm to humans as a condition of ethical validity.

A system satisfies HHPM only if:

- avoidable human harm is not accepted as a normal operating condition
- harmful pathways are identified before deployment or reliance
- prevention logic exists before damage occurs
- operational capability does not override human safety
- system validity is denied where preventable human harm remains structurally tolerated

A system that tolerates avoidable human harm does not satisfy HHPM.

## Module Function

HHPM defines the first ethical boundary of validity.

It ensures that no methodology, system, or technology may pass ethical layer conditions if it permits preventable human harm through design, deployment, escalation failure, neglect, or structurally tolerated risk.

The module applies wherever human beings may be affected directly or indirectly by system behavior.

## Minimum Implementation Framework (MIF)

### Step 1 — Define Human Exposure

The organization must define how humans may be affected by the system.

Minimum requirement:

- affected human groups are identifiable
  - direct and indirect exposure pathways are recognized
  - human impact is not treated as undefined externality
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## Step 2 — Define Harm Pathways

The organization must identify where avoidable harm may occur.

Minimum requirement:

- harmful outcomes are explicitly mapped
  - structural risk pathways are visible
  - silent tolerance of predictable harm is excluded
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## Step 3 — Define Prevention Logic

The system must include prevention before reliance.

Minimum requirement:

- preventive conditions are defined
  - harm reduction is not deferred to post-failure correction only
  - safety is not replaced by assumption or goodwill
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## Step 4 — Define Escalation and Stop Conditions

The system must define when operation must stop, escalate, or be restricted to prevent harm.

Minimum requirement:

- stop conditions are explicit
  - escalation logic exists
  - continued operation under harmful conditions is not treated as valid
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## Step 5 — Preserve Human Priority

Human safety must remain structurally superior to convenience, speed, efficiency, or output.

Minimum requirement:

- operational gain does not override human protection
  - performance does not justify preventable human harm
  - system legitimacy remains subordinate to human safety
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## Step 6 — Restrict Invalid Deployment

The system must not be treated as ethically valid if preventable harm remains structurally possible and ungoverned.

Minimum requirement:

- invalid deployment conditions are identifiable
- unresolved human harm pathways block ethical passage
- functionality alone does not restore validity

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## Use Case 1 — Autonomous Human-Facing System

### Scenario

An autonomous system is prepared for deployment in an environment where humans may be affected by its decisions, actions, or response failures.

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### Application

HHPM is used to ensure:

- human exposure is defined
- preventable harm pathways are identified
- stop and escalation conditions exist
- performance does not override safety validity

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### Result

The organization gains a stronger basis for preventing deployment of a system that works technically but remains ethically invalid because avoidable human harm is still structurally tolerated.

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## Use Case 2 — Enterprise AI Decision Environment

### Scenario

An organization uses AI to support decisions affecting people through ranking, filtering, approval, intervention, or operational prioritization.

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### Application

HHPM is used to ensure:

- indirect human impact is mapped
  - harmful decision pathways are identified
  - prevention logic exists before reliance
  - efficiency does not override ethical human protection
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## Result

The organization gains a stronger ethical gate preventing systems from being treated as valid merely because they are efficient, scalable, or commercially useful.

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## Canonical Closing Statement

**If avoidable human harm remains structurally possible, ethical validity has not been achieved.**

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## Canonical Source

<https://originopenfoundation.org/>